academicthesis

User guide

Writing a thesis with the LUISS and Politecnico di Milano packages

This guide is for students who write their thesis with academicthesis. It explains how to compile a thesis, every class option and data field, what each university and format requires, and gives a complete example for each layout.

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1 About this guide

academicthesis is a LaTeX class that typesets a thesis in the format prescribed by a university. You choose the university, the degree and, where a university offers several, the format; you give the data of your thesis once; the class produces the cover page, front matter and page layout. This guide covers the two university packages documented so far:

- academicthesis-luiss, for LUISS Guido Carli (bachelor's, master's and doctoral theses), Section 9;
- academicthesis-polimi, for Politecnico di Milano (classical, article and Executive Summary formats, and the doctoral dissertation), Section 10.

Sections 2–8 describe what is common to every university; read them first, then the section of your university. Section 11 lists the most common error messages and how to fix them, and Appendix A is a one-page reference.

Conventions. Commands are written `\thesissetup`, options and keys `format=classical`, files `example.tex`. "Required" means that compilation stops with an error naming the field when it is missing; "optional" means it is printed only when given.

2 Installing and compiling

2.1 Requirements

- A recent TeX distribution: TeX Live or MacTeX 2023 or later, or an up-to-date MiKTeX. The class is written in LaTeX3 and needs a modern kernel.
- **pdfLaTeX** is the reference engine and the one used by all the examples. XeLaTeX and LuaLaTeX are also accepted (the class then loads fontspec).
- For the bibliography, biblatex with biber (both part of a full TeX distribution). Without them the class falls back to natbib and BibTeX (Section 8).

2.2 Which files you need

The class is a collection of small packages that load one another by name:

Files	Needed for
`academicthesis.cls`, `academicthesis-kernel.sty`	Always (the core).
`academicthesis-english.ldf`, `-italian.ldf`, `-french.ldf`	The languages you use.
`universities/luiss/*`	A LUISS thesis.
`universities/polimi/*`	A Politecnico di Milano thesis.

Any of these three set-ups works:

1. **Inside the repository** (simplest). Put your thesis in the `showcases/` folder, or copy a showcase and keep its first line, `\input{academicthesis-repo-paths}`, which tells LaTeX where the package folders are. Then compile with any editor, or with

```
cd showcases
```

```
latexmk my-thesis.tex
```

2. **Next to your thesis.** Copy the files listed above into the folder of your thesis (no subfolders needed), and remove the `\input{academicthesis-repo-paths}` line. This is also the way to use the class on Overleaf: upload the files to the project.
3. **Installed in your personal TEX tree**, for example under `~/Library/texmf/tex/latex/academicthesis/` (macOS) or `~/texmf/tex/latex/academicthesis/` (Linux). Every thesis on the computer can then use the class with no extra line.

Editors

Texifier/Texpad, TeXShop, TeXstudio, VS Code (LaTeX Workshop) and Overleaf all work. In Texifier/Texpad, set the typesetter to *TeX Live (pdfLaTeX)*: its built-in engine is too old for this class.

2.3 Compiling

Run pdfLaTeX twice (for the table of contents), and biber between the two runs when you have a bibliography. `latexmk` does all of this by itself:

```
latexmk -pdf my-thesis.tex
```

3 Anatomy of a thesis

Every thesis has the same four parts, whatever the university:

```
% 1. Class options: university, degree, format, language
\documentclass[university=luiss, master, language=english]{academicthesis}

% 2. Your own packages (optional)
\usepackage{amssymb}
\usepackage{hyperref}

% 3. The data of the thesis
\thesissetup{
  title        = {Title of the Thesis},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  degree       = {Economics and Management},
  chair        = {Corporate Finance},
  supervisor   = {Prof. Name Surname},
  academicyear = {2025/2026},
}
\addbibresource{references.bib}

% 4. The document
\begin{document}
\frontpage                        % cover page (and second page, if any)

\frontmatter                      % roman page numbers
\begin{abstractthesis}[keywords = {first, second}]
  The abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\tableofcontents
```

```
\mainmatter                          % arabic page numbers
\chapter{Introduction}
...
\printbibliography

\backmatter
\begin{acknowledgements}
  Thanks to ...
\end{acknowledgements}
\end{document}
```

`\frontpage` prints the cover page of your university, degree and format from the data given in `\thesissetup`. Everything after it is ordinary LaTeX: chapters, sections, figures, tables and so on.

4 Class options

All options go between the square brackets of `\documentclass[...]{academicthesis}`.

Option	Values	Meaning
`university` (or `uni`)	`luiss`, `polimi`	The university whose format is used. Required.
degree	`bachelor`, `master`, `phd`	The degree. Written on its own, without `degree=`. Default: `bachelor`.
`format`	depends on the university	The layout, for universities that offer several (PoliMi: `classical`, `article`, `summary`, `phd`). LUISS has a single layout and does not accept `format`.
`language` (or `lang`)	`english`, `italian`, `french`	Main language of the thesis: every printed label, and hyphenation. Default: `english`. Also accepted: `lang=en`, `lang=it`, `lang=fr`, or just `italian`.
`other-languages`	e.g. `{italian,french}`	Other languages used by single blocks (Section 6), so that their hyphenation is right. PoliMi always loads English and Italian.
`secondpage`, `no-secondpage`		Print or omit the second page after the cover (Section 7). Default: on for LUISS, off for PoliMi.
`discussion`, `no-discussion`		Whether the thesis has been defended; it changes the second page and makes `examdate` required. Default: off.
`biblatex-options`	e.g. `{style=apa}`	Options passed to biblatex (Section 8).
anything else	e.g. `11pt`, `oneside`, `twoside`	Passed to the base class (book or article). Your choice wins over the university's default.

5 The data of your thesis

All the data printed on the cover and on the second page is given with one command in the preamble, `\thesissetup`, as a list of `key = {value}` pairs. The key names are the same at every university; only the printed labels change (for example LUISS prints "Supervisor", PoliMi "Advisor").

Key	What to write
`title`	Title of the thesis.
`subtitle`	Subtitle, printed under the title when given.
`candidate`	Your name, as it should be printed: `{Name Surname}`.
`idnumber`	Student ID number (*matricola*).
`gender`	`male` or `female` (also `m`, `f`). Only changes Italian labels: "Candidato" / "Candidata".
`degree`	The degree programme, without "Course of" or "Master's Thesis in", which the cover adds: `{Economics and Management}`.
`chair`	LUISS: the chair (*cattedra*) of the thesis, without "Chair of".
`department`	The department: LUISS PhD without "Department of" (the cover adds it); PoliMi PhD in full, as it should be printed.
`phdtitle`	The doctoral programme: LUISS without "PhD in"; PoliMi in full (`{Doctoral Program in ...}`).
`cycle`	PhD cycle, e.g. `XXXVIII`.
`academicyear`	Academic year, written as your university writes it: `2025/2026`, `2025-26`.
`supervisor`	One supervisor (advisor), with title: `{Prof. Name Surname}`.
`supervisors`	Several supervisors, separated by commas: `{Prof. A, Prof. B}`.
`cosupervisor`, `cosupervisors`	Co-supervisor(s) (co-advisors), in the same way.
`tutor`, `tutors`	PoliMi PhD: tutor(s).
`coordinator`	PoliMi PhD: chair (coordinator) of the doctoral programme.
`abstract`, `keywords`	PoliMi `article` format: the English abstract and its keywords, printed on page 1.
`copyyear`	Second page: year of the copyright notice.
`authoremail`	Second page: contact e-mail.
`website`	Second page: website.
`examdate`	Second page, with the `discussion` option: date of the defence.
`examiner`, `examiners`	Second page, with `discussion`: members of the committee, comma-separated.

One person or several

`supervisor` takes one name and keeps any comma in it; `supervisors` splits its value at the commas. The label adapts by itself: "Supervisor" for one name, "Supervisors" for

two or more. The same holds for `cosupervisor(s)`, `tutor(s)` and `examiner(s)`. Write academic titles (“Prof.”, “Dr.”) yourself.

`\thesissetup` can be used several times; a later value replaces an earlier one. Which keys are required depends on the university, the degree and the format: see the tables in Sections 9 and 10. Keys that a layout does not use are simply ignored.

6 Front-matter blocks

The core class provides four blocks. Each university gives them its own look, but they are written the same way everywhere.

Block	Options	Default heading (English)
`\begin{abstractthesis}`	`language`, `keywords`, `title`	Abstract
`\begin{originality}`	`language`, `title`	Statement of Originality
`\begin{acknowledgements}`	`language`, `title`	Acknowledgments
`\dedication[...]{text}`	`language`	(none: the text on its own page)

- `language=` writes the block in another language: its heading, the “Keywords” label and the hyphenation follow that language. Without it, the block uses the main language of the thesis. List the extra language in the `other-languages` class option (not needed for Italian and English at PoliMi).
- `keywords=` prints the keywords after the abstract.
- `title=` replaces the default heading.

Abstracts, statements of originality and acknowledgements appear in the table of contents. For example, an English thesis with an Italian abstract:

```
\documentclass[university=luiss, master, language=english,
               other-languages={italian}]{academicthesis}
...
\begin{abstractthesis}[keywords = {corporate finance, valuation}]
  The English abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\begin{abstractthesis}[language = italian,
                       keywords = {finanza aziendale, valutazione}]
  L'abstract in italiano.
\end{abstractthesis}
\dedication{To my family.}
```

7 The second page

Some universities print, right after the cover, a page with the examination details and a copyright notice. `\frontpage` adds it when it is on: by default for LUISS, not for PoliMi. Switch it with the class options `secondpage` and `no-secondpage`.

- **Top of the page.** Without the `discussion` option: “The present thesis has not been defended.” With `discussion`: the date of the defence (`examdate`, then required) and the committee (`examiners`).

- **Bottom of the page.** The title, "© `copyyear` `candidate`", a reservation of rights, the author, and the contact e-mail and website when given (`authoremail`, `website`).

Give `copyyear` whenever the second page is printed, or the notice will have no year.

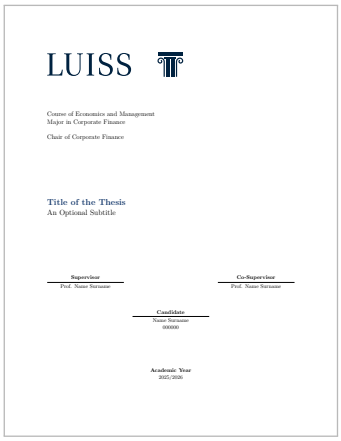
8 Bibliography

The class loads biblatex with biber for you. The style is, in order of priority: the one you give with the class option `biblatex-options`; the university's default (LUISS: author–year); otherwise numeric.

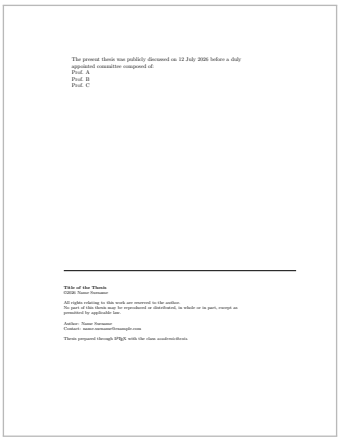
```
\documentclass[university=polimi, master,
               biblatex-options={style=numeric-comp, sorting=none}]{academicthesis}
\addbibresource{references.bib}   % in the preamble
...
\printbibliography                % where the bibliography goes
```

Do not load biblatex again yourself. If biblatex is not installed, the class warns and uses natbib with BibTEX, keeping the same two commands, so the thesis still compiles.

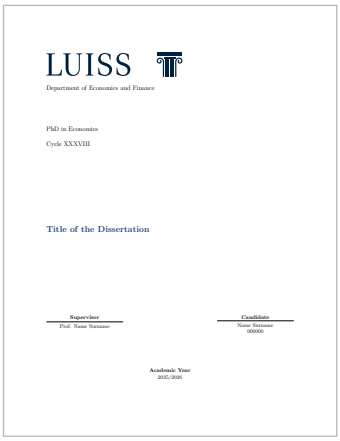
9 LUISS Guido Carli



Bachelor's / master's cover



Second page (with `discussion`)



PhD cover

9.1 At a glance

Class line	`\documentclass[university=luiss, master]{academicthesis}`
Degrees	`bachelor`, `master`, `phd`
Formats	one; the `format` option is not used
Base class	book, with the class defaults (add `twoside`, `12pt`, … as you wish)
Second page	on (`no-secondpage` to omit it)
Bibliography	author–year (biblatex, biber)
Languages	English, Italian or French labels, after the `language` option

9.2 What the cover shows

Bachelor's and master's thesis, from top to bottom: the LUISS logo; "Course of `degree`" (Italian: "Corso di Laurea"); the major, when given; "Chair of `chair`" ("Cattedra"); the title in LUISS blue and the subtitle; the supervisor(s) on the left, the co-supervisor(s) on the right and the candidate with the student ID below them (or, without a co-supervisor, supervisor on the left and candidate on the right); the academic year at the bottom.

PhD thesis: the same page, with "Department of `department`" under the logo, "PhD in `phdtitle`" in place of the course, and "Cycle `cycle`" in place of the chair.

9.3 Thesis data

Key	Printed as	Bachelor / master	PhD
`title`	Title, in LUISS blue	**required**	**required**
`subtitle`	Under the title	optional	optional
`candidate`	"Candidate" column	**required**	**required**
`idnumber`	Under the candidate's name	optional	optional
`degree`	"Course of . . . "	**required**	—
`chair`	"Chair of . . . "	**required**	—
`department`	"Department of . . . "	—	**required**
`phdtitle`	"PhD in . . . "	—	**required**
`cycle`	"Cycle . . . "	—	**required**
`supervisor(s)`	"Supervisor(s)" column	**required**	**required**
`cosupervisor(s)`	"Co-Supervisor(s)" column	optional	optional
`academicyear`	"Academic Year"	**required**	**required**
`gender`	"Candidato" / "Candidata" (Italian)	optional	optional
`copyyear`, `authoremail`, `website`	Second page	recommended	recommended
`examdate`, `examiners`	Second page	with `discussion`	with `discussion`

The major (bachelor's and master's) is LUISS-specific and is set with its own command, or with `\luissthesissetup`; either line below works. It is printed as written, between the course and the chair.

```
\major{Major in Corporate Finance}
\luissthesissetup{major = {Major in Corporate Finance}}
```

9.4 Adjusting the cover: \luissthesissetup

Key	Default	Effect
logo-file	logoluissblue	Logo image (file name without extension). luiss is also shipped.
logo-width	0.55\textwidth	Width of the logo.
logo-align	left	left, center or right.
title-align	left	Title and subtitle.
course-align	left	Course and chair block (PhD: programme and cycle).
major-align	left	The major line.
department-align	left	PhD: the department line.
major		The major (see above).

The alignment keys other than logo-align also accept the short forms l, c, r. Example: \luissthesissetup{logo-align=center, title-align=center}.

9.5 Example: bachelor's or master's thesis

```
\documentclass[university=luiss, master, language=english, twoside,
               discussion, other-languages={italian}]{academicthesis}

\major{Major in Corporate Finance}

\thesissetup{
  title        = {Title of the Thesis},
  subtitle     = {An Optional Subtitle},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  idnumber     = {000000},
  degree       = {Economics and Management},
  chair        = {Corporate Finance},
  supervisor   = {Prof. Name Surname},
  cosupervisor = {Prof. Name Surname},
  academicyear = {2025/2026},
  copyyear     = {2026},
  authoremail  = {name.surname@example.com},
  examdate     = {12 July 2026},              % because of `discussion'
  examiners    = {Prof. A, Prof. B, Prof. C},
}
\addbibresource{references.bib}

\begin{document}
\frontpage

\frontmatter
\begin{abstractthesis}[keywords = {first, second}]
  The abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\begin{abstractthesis}[language = italian, keywords = {primo, secondo}]
  Il sommario in italiano.
\end{abstractthesis}
\dedication{To my family.}
```

```
\tableofcontents

\mainmatter
\chapter{Introduction}
...
\printbibliography

\backmatter
\begin{acknowledgements}
  Thanks to ...
\end{acknowledgements}
\end{document}
```

For a bachelor's thesis, write `bachelor` instead of `master`. Without `discussion`, leave out `examdate` and `examiners`; the second page then says that the thesis has not been defended.

9.6 Example: PhD thesis

```
\documentclass[university=luiss, phd, language=english, twoside]{academicthesis}

\thesissetup{
  title        = {Title of the Dissertation},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  idnumber     = {000000},
  department   = {Economics and Finance},   % "Department of ..."
  phdtitle     = {Economics},               % "PhD in ..."
  cycle        = {XXXVIII},                % "Cycle ..."
  supervisors  = {Prof. Name Surname},
  academicyear = {2025/2026},
  copyyear     = {2026},
}

\begin{document}
\frontpage
\frontmatter
\begin{abstractthesis} The abstract. \end{abstractthesis}
\tableofcontents
\mainmatter
\chapter{Introduction}
...
\end{document}
```

Complete versions are in `showcases/example-luiss-bachelor.tex` and `showcases/example-luiss-phd.tex`.

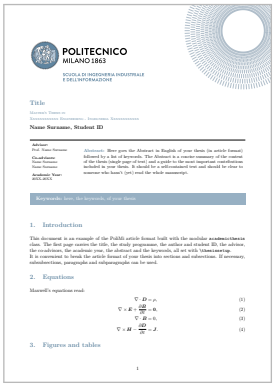
10 Politecnico di Milano

The PoliMi layouts are Politecnico di Milano's design

The `classical`, `article` and `summary` formats reproduce the official thesis templates of the School of Industrial and Information Engineering (Scuola 3I) of Politecnico di Milano, revision of October 2021 (*Thesis classical format*, *Thesis article format*, *Executive Summary*). The `phd` format reproduces the PoliMi doctoral dissertation template (`phdthesis.sty`, `phdtitle.sty`). The page designs, colours, logos, seal and "raggiera" belong to Politecnico di Milano; this package re-implements them on the academicthesis core and is not the original author of the design. Check your school's current rules before submitting.



`classical`



`article`



`summary`



`phd`

10.1 At a glance

Format	What it is	Degrees	Base class
`classical`	The full thesis as a book. Default for bachelor and master.	bachelor, master	book, 12pt, two-sided, A4
`article`	The thesis as a paper, with the abstract on page 1.	bachelor, master	article, 11pt, A4
`summary`	The Executive Summary, in two columns.	bachelor, master	article, 11pt, 2 col., A4
`phd`	The doctoral dissertation. Default for `phd`.	phd	book, 10pt, 17×24 cm

- Class line: `\documentclass[university=polimi, master, format=classical]{academicthesis}`.
- No second page (add it with `secondpage` if you need it).
- English and Italian are always loaded, so the Italian abstract needs no `other-languages`.
- The package sets no bibliography style; the default is numeric (Section 8).

10.2 Thesis data

Key	Printed as (English / Italian)	classical	article	summary
`title`	Title, in blue	**required**	**required**	**required**
`subtitle`	Under the title	optional	optional	optional
`candidate`	Author / Candidato	**required**	**required**	**required**
`idnumber`	Student ID / Matricola	**required**	**required**	—
`degree`	after “Master’s Thesis in” / “Tesi di Laurea Magistrale in”	**required**	**required**	**required**
`supervisor(s)`	Advisor(s) / Relatore, Relatori	**required**	**required**	**required**
`cosupervisor(s)`	Co-advisor(s) / Correlatore, Correlatori	optional	optional	optional
`academicyear`	Academic Year / Anno Accademico	**required**	**required**	**required**
`abstract`	English abstract on page 1	—	**required**	—
`keywords`	Keywords of that abstract, in a blue box	—	optional	—
`gender`	Candidato / Candidata (Italian)	optional	optional	optional

For a bachelor’s thesis the cover reads “Bachelor’s Thesis in” (“Tesi di Laurea Triennale in”).

PhD (`format=phd`)

Key	Printed as (English / Italian)	Required
`title`, `subtitle`	Title; subtitle when given	title
`candidate`	Under “Doctoral Dissertation of” / “Tesi di Dottorato di”	**required**
`department`	In full, e.g. “Department of Electronics, Information and Bioengineering”	**required**
`phdtitle`	In full, e.g. “Doctoral Program in Information Technology”	**required**
`supervisor(s)`	Supervisor(s) / Relatore, Relatori	**required**
`tutor(s)`	Tutor(s) / Tutor	optional
`coordinator`	The Chair of the Doctoral Program / Il Coordinatore del Dottorato	optional
`academicyear`, `cycle`	Bottom line: “2025–2026 – Cycle XXXVIII”	**required**

10.3 Options: \polimithesissetup

Key	Default	Effect
logo-file	logopolimi3i	Logo on the cover or first page (file name without extension). The phd format uses the round seal, logopolimiseal, instead.
watermark	true	The "raggiera" in the background of the cover, of page 1 and of blank pages. false removes it. Not used by phd.
paper	17x24	phd only: 17x24 (17×24 cm, as in the template) or a4.

10.4 The classical format

A4, 12pt, two-sided, 1.5 line spacing, no paragraph indent. The cover has the Scuola 3I logo, the title in blue, "Master's Thesis in degree", "Author: candidate" and, at the bottom, student ID, advisor(s), co-advisor(s) and academic year. Chapters open with a large blue number and bar; starred chapters (\chapter*{Introduction}) still enter the table of contents and the running header. \blankpage inserts an empty page with the raggiera.

```
\documentclass[university=polimi, master, format=classical,
               language=english]{academicthesis}
\usepackage{amssymb, bm, float, colortbl}
\usepackage[colorlinks=true, linkcolor=black, citecolor=black]{hyperref}

\thesissetup{
  title         = {Title},
  candidate     = {Name Surname},
  idnumber      = {000000},
  degree        = {Xxxxxxx Engineering - Ingegneria Xxxxxxx},
  supervisor    = {Prof. Name Surname},
  cosupervisors = {Name Surname, Name Surname},
  academicyear  = {2025-26},
}
\addbibresource{references.bib}

\begin{document}
\frontpage

\frontmatter
\begin{abstractthesis}[keywords = {first, second, third}]
  English abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\begin{abstractthesis}[language = italian, keywords = {primo, secondo}]
  Abstract in lingua italiana.
\end{abstractthesis}
\tableofcontents

\mainmatter
\chapter*{Introduction}
\chapter{Chapter one}
...
\printbibliography
\appendix
\chapter{Appendix A}
```

```
\backmatter
\listoffigures
\listoftables
\begin{acknowledgements} Thanks to ... \end{acknowledgements}
\end{document}
```

10.5 The `article` format

A4, 11pt, 2 cm margins. There is no separate cover: `\frontpage` prints a header block on page 1 (logo, title, programme, "author, student ID", advisors and academic year beside the **English abstract**, and the keywords in a blue box), and the text starts right below. The abstract is therefore given in `\thesissetup`. Use `\section`, not `\chapter`: the article class has no chapters (a `\chapter` still compiles, as a section, with a warning).

```
\documentclass[university=polimi, master, format=article,
               language=english]{academicthesis}
\thesissetup{
  title        = {Title},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  idnumber     = {000000},
  degree       = {Xxxxxxx Engineering - Ingegneria Xxxxxxx},
  supervisor   = {Prof. Name Surname},
  academicyear = {2025-26},
  abstract     = {The English abstract, printed on page 1.},
  keywords     = {here, the keywords},
}
\begin{document}
\frontpage
\section{Introduction}
...
\appendix
\section{Appendix A}
\clearpage
\begin{abstractthesis}[language = italian, keywords = {qui, le parole chiave}]
  Abstract in lingua italiana.
\end{abstractthesis}
\begin{acknowledgements} ... \end{acknowledgements}
\end{document}
```

10.6 The `summary` format (Executive Summary)

A4, 11pt, two columns. Page 1 opens with a full-width block (logo, "Executive Summary of the Thesis", title, programme, author, advisor(s), co-advisor(s), academic year); the following pages have a blue header with "Executive summary" and the author. The student ID is not printed and not required. As in the template, the summary usually ends with a short bibliography.

```
\documentclass[university=polimi, master, format=summary,
               language=english]{academicthesis}
\thesissetup{
  title        = {Title of the thesis},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  degree       = {Xxxxxxx Engineering - Ingegneria Xxxxxxx},
  supervisor   = {Prof. Name Surname},
```

```
  cosupervisor = {Name Surname},
  academicyear = {2025-26},
}
\begin{document}
\frontpage
\section{Introduction}
...
\printbibliography
\end{document}
```

10.7 The phd format (doctoral dissertation)

10pt, two-sided, chapters on right-hand pages, 17×24 cm by default (set `paper=a4` in `\polimithesissetup` for A4), Times for the text and Helvetica for headings. The cover carries the PoliMi seal, "Politecnico di Milano", the department and doctoral programme, the title, the author on the right, the supervisor, tutor and chair of the programme on the left, and the academic year and cycle at the bottom. A `defn` (Definition) environment is provided.

```
\documentclass[university=polimi, phd, language=english]{academicthesis}
\thesissetup{
  title        = {Title},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  department   = {Department of Electronics, Information and Bioengineering},
  phdtitle     = {Doctoral Program in Information Technology},
  supervisor   = {Prof. Name Surname},
  tutor        = {Prof. Name Surname},
  coordinator  = {Prof. Name Surname},
  academicyear = {2025--2026},
  cycle        = {XXXVIII},
}
\begin{document}
\frontpage
\frontmatter
\begin{abstractthesis} The abstract. \end{abstractthesis}
\tableofcontents
\mainmatter
\chapter{Introduction}
...
\end{document}
```

The `phd` degree selects `format=phd` by itself; `format=phd` with `bachelor` or `master` is an error.

10.8 Colours, theorems and other helpers

- The colour `bluepoli` is defined in every format (also as `bluePoli` in `article` and `summary`, the name used by the official templates): `\rowcolor{bluepoli!40}` (with colortbl).
- `theorem` and `proposition` environments are ready, with blue headings; your own `\newtheorem`s take the same style.
- Figure and table caption labels are blue.
- Packages such as hyperref, cleveref, amssymb, bm, float, colortbl, subfig, tikz and algorithm are left to you, as in the official templates.

Complete versions are in `showcases/example-polimi-classical.tex`, `-article.tex`, `-summary.tex` and `-phd.tex`. The package's own manual, `universities/polimi/academicthesis-polimi-doc.pdf`, gives further detail on each layout.

11 Common errors and how to fix them

Message (abridged)	Cause	Fix
Missing required thesis metadata: '*key*'	A required field is not in `\thesissetup`	Add it; the message shows an example. Tables in Sections 9 and 10.
Missing required thesis metadata: 'examdate'	`discussion` without the defence date	Add `examdate`, or remove `discussion`.
Unknown format '*x*' for university 'polimi'	Typo in `format`	Use `classical`, `article`, `summary` or `phd`.
format=phd is the PoliMi doctoral dissertation: use the 'phd' degree	`format=phd` with `bachelor` or `master`	Use the `phd` degree.
No front page registered for university '*u*', degree '*d*'	A degree the layout does not offer	Check the degree and format options.
File 'academicthesis.cls' not found	LaTeX cannot see the class files	See Section 2: keep the line that inputs `academicthesis-repo-paths`, or copy the files next to the thesis.
Warning: The base class 'article' has no chapters	`\chapter` in PoliMi `article` or `summary`	Use `\section`.
Warning: 'french' ... was not loaded by babel	A block with `language=french`	Add `french` to the `other-languages` option.
Warning: biblatex is not available	biblatex not installed	Install it, or keep the natbib fallback.

Errors from Texifier's built-in engine (for example about LaTeX3 commands) disappear when the typesetter is set to TeX Live (pdfLaTeX).

A Quick reference

```
% ---- LUISS ------------------------------------------------------------
\documentclass[university=luiss, bachelor|master|phd,
               language=english|italian|french,
               no-secondpage, discussion]{academicthesis}
\luissthesissetup{ major = {...}, logo-align = left|center|right,
                   title-align = ..., course-align = ... }
% bachelor/master: title candidate degree chair supervisor(s) academicyear
% phd:             title candidate department phdtitle cycle
%                  supervisor(s) academicyear
% optional:        subtitle idnumber cosupervisor(s) copyyear authoremail
%                  website  (+ examdate examiners with `discussion')

% ---- Politecnico di Milano --------------------------------------------
\documentclass[university=polimi, bachelor|master,
               format=classical|article|summary,
               language=english|italian]{academicthesis}
\documentclass[university=polimi, phd]{academicthesis}       % format=phd
\polimithesissetup{ logo-file = ..., watermark = true|false,
                    paper = 17x24|a4 }                        % paper: phd
% classical: title candidate idnumber degree supervisor(s) academicyear
% article:   + abstract (keywords optional)
% summary:   as classical, without idnumber
% phd:       title candidate department phdtitle supervisor(s)
%            academicyear cycle   (tutor(s), coordinator optional)

% ---- Blocks (every university) ----------------------------------------
\begin{abstractthesis}[language=..., keywords=..., title=...]
  ... \end{abstractthesis}
\begin{originality}[language=..., title=...] ... \end{originality}
\begin{acknowledgements}[language=..., title=...]
  ... \end{acknowledgements}
\dedication[language=...]{...}
```

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